HOW WATER IS TREATED

An old filter doesn't clean your water.

It can grow bacteria instead.

SWIPE →

WHAT'S INSIDE?

Activated carbon

The core of a pitcher filter cartridge is activated carbon, often made from coconut shells.

It is full of tiny pores. One gram has an internal surface area of over 500 m^2, bigger than a basketball court.

WHAT DOES IT CATCH?

Odour, taste, chlorine

Chlorine, odours and some organic compounds stick to those pores. This is called adsorption.

The ion-exchange resin in the cartridge reduces some hardness, so limescale builds up in your kettle more slowly.

WHAT DOESN'T IT CATCH?

Bacteria and viruses

A standard carbon filter does not kill microbes.

It also barely removes dissolved substances like fluoride and nitrate.

So if your tap water is unsafe, a pitcher filter won't make it safe.

THE REAL PROBLEM

Chlorine gone, microbes stay

The filter removes chlorine, so nothing is left to keep bacteria in check.

Inside the wet carbon they settle in and multiply.

In a 2004 University of Arizona study, the highest bacteria counts were found in filtered water.

USE IT RIGHT

3 simple rules

1. Replace the cartridge at least every 4 weeks
2. Keep filtered water in the fridge
3. Drink it within a day, wash the pitcher often

> Manufacturers give the same advice.

Send this to one friend who doesn't know it.

Especially if they own a filter pitcher.

@suvyektiv